

WATER SAFETY

Student Lesson Outline

Health & Physical Education · Year 7–8 · Victorian Curriculum F–10 Version 2.0
VCHPEP125 · VCHPEP126 · VCHPEP129 · VCHPEP130 · VCHPEM146

5-lesson unit with learning intentions, success criteria, key vocabulary, and end-of-lesson reflection prompts. Distribute to students at the start of the unit.

TEACHER

Unit Overview — What You Will Know, Understand, and Do

By end of unit you will KNOW	By end of unit you will UNDERSTAND	By end of unit you will DO
Victorian & global drowning statistics Beach flag meanings & rip escape DRS ABCD emergency action plan SwimSafe 5 rules CPR ratio, rate, and depth Hidden inland waterway hazards	Why most Victorian drowning deaths occur at unpatrolled locations Why peer pressure and the bystander effect increase risk Why structural factors drive CALD drowning disproportionality Why "Throw, Don't Go" saves lives	Identify beach flag meanings and explain correct responses Apply DRS ABCD correctly in a scenario Explain the SwimSafe rules to someone else Design a water safety communication product for a real audience Perform a survival float and distress signal (practical component)

Prior knowledge expected:

This unit builds on primary school water safety education. If you have not covered water safety recently, speak to your teacher about a catch-up summary.

LESSON 1 Victoria's Drowning Crisis — Why It Matters to You

VCHPEP125 · VCHPEP126

Learning Intention

We are learning to analyse Victorian and global drowning data to understand who is at risk, where drownings occur, and why this issue matters for young Victorians.

Success Criteria

(tick each when you feel confident)

- I can state key Victorian drowning statistics (total deaths, male vs female, patrolled vs unpatrolled) from memory and explain what they mean. [VCHPEP126]
- I can explain why ALL 54 Victorian drowning deaths in 2023–24 occurred at unpatrolled locations — and what this tells us about where to swim. [VCHPEP125]
- I can describe at least two reasons why CALD communities are over-represented in Victorian drowning statistics, using structural rather than individual explanations. [VCHPEP126]

Key Vocabulary

drowning rate · patrolled · unpatrolled · CALD · over-represented · non-fatal drowning · LSV · Victorian Drowning Report

End-of-Lesson Reflection

- What is the single most surprising statistic from today — and what does it make you want to change?

LESSON 2**Beach Flags, Signals & Rip Current Survival**

VCHPEP129 · VCHPEP130

Learning Intention

We are learning to identify beach flag meanings and water hazard signals, and apply the correct rip current escape technique using our knowledge of how rips work.

Success Criteria

(tick each when you feel confident)

- I can correctly identify and explain all four main beach flags: red and yellow, single red, orange windsock, and purple. [VCHPEP130]
- I can describe the correct rip current escape technique in the correct sequence (stay calm → float → swim parallel → angle back → signal). [VCHPEP129]
- I can explain why it is dangerous to swim against a rip current and what happens to the body when a swimmer does. [VCHPEP130]
- I can identify what the orange windsock flag means and explain the specific risk it signals for people using inflatables. [VCHPEP130]

Key Vocabulary

red and yellow flags · single red flag · orange windsock flag · purple flag · rip current · offshore wind · survival float · distress signal

**End-of-Lesson Reflection**

If a friend said "let's swim here — the water looks calm," what would you say? What would you point to?

LESSON 3**Emergency Response — DRS ABCD & Rescue Skills**

VCHPEP129 · VCHPEM146

Learning Intention

We are learning to apply the DRS ABCD emergency action plan correctly and explain the principles of safe water rescue — including why Throw, Don't Go saves lives.

Success Criteria

(tick each when you feel confident)

- ☐ I can name all seven steps of DRS ABCD in the correct order and explain what to do at each step. [VCHPEP129]
- ☐ I can explain exactly what to say to a 000 operator, including what information to provide and in what order. [VCHPEP129]
- ☐ I can explain the 30:2 CPR ratio, the correct compression rate (100–120 bpm) and depth (5–6cm), and why each matters. [VCHPEM146]
- ☐ I can explain "Throw, Don't Go" — why untrained rescuers should not enter the water and what to do instead. [VCHPEP129]

Key Vocabulary

DRS ABCD · cardiac arrest · CPR · 30:2 · AED · defibrillation · Throw Don't Go · secondary drowning · 000

**End-of-Lesson Reflection**

Walk through DRS ABCD from memory. Which step do you feel least confident about — and why?

LESSON 4**Hazard Mapping, Safe Decisions & Inland Waterways**

VCHPEP125 · VCHPEP129

Learning Intention

We are learning to identify hidden hazards at inland waterways and apply the SwimSafe 5 rules as a decision-making framework in realistic scenarios.

Success Criteria

(tick each when you feel confident)

- ☐ I can name and explain all five LSV SwimSafe rules and give a specific real-life situation where each one is most important. [VCHPEP125]
- ☐ I can identify at least five hidden hazards at inland waterways (rivers, dams, lakes) that are not visible from the surface. [VCHPEP125]
- ☐ I can explain why a location that was safe before (e.g. a river crossing) can become dangerous after rain — using specific physical reasons. [VCHPEP129]
- ☐ I can describe how the bystander effect works and give a specific strategy to overcome it in a water emergency. [VCHPEP129]

Key Vocabulary

SwimSafe 5 rules · inland waterway · dam · bystander effect · cold water shock · 1-10-1 rule · hidden hazards · risk assessment

**End-of-Lesson Reflection**

Think of a place you go near water. Identify one hazard you hadn't noticed before this unit. What will you do differently?

LESSON 5**Personal Action Plan & Communication Campaign**

VCHPEP126 · VCHPEP129

Learning Intention

We are learning to synthesise our unit knowledge into a personal water safety action plan and a communication product designed for a specific real audience.

Success Criteria

(tick each when you feel confident)

- ☐ I can produce a personal water safety action plan that identifies at least three specific actions I will take — with reasons linked to unit content. [VCHPEP126]
- ☐ I can design a water safety communication product for a named audience, using at least one statistic cited with a source URL. [VCHPEP126]
- ☐ I can evaluate my communication product against two criteria: accuracy of information and appropriateness for the target audience. [VCHPEP129]

Key Vocabulary

target audience · communication product · health message · call to action · primary source · evidence-based · AAPPC framework

**End-of-Lesson Reflection**

Unit reflection: What is the most important thing you learned in this whole unit? What question does it leave you with?

ASSESSMENT OVERVIEW

Year 7–8 Water Safety Unit

Assessment type	When	What you need to show	Curriculum code
Exit tickets (lessons 1–4)	End of each lesson	A brief written response to the lesson reflection question	VCHPEP125–130
Scenario discussion	Lessons 2–4	Active participation in group scenario analysis with reasoning based on unit content	VCHPEP129
Pool practical assessment	Lesson 4 (pool)	Survival float 2 min, 50m swim, throw rescue technique, distress signal	VCHPEM146
Student self-assessment	Lesson 6 (end of unit)	Honest self-rating across all content areas + 5 reflection questions + one goal	VCHPEP125–130
Communication product	Lesson 5 (end of unit)	Water safety product for a named real audience, with at least one cited statistic	VCHPEP126
Student digital portfolio	Ongoing — submitted end of unit	Collected evidence of learning across all 5 lessons	VCHPEP125–130

A-standard work at Year 7–8 goes beyond description:

A-standard responses in this unit explain WHY and HOW, not just WHAT. They connect statistics to structural causes, apply content to new scenarios, and use unit vocabulary accurately. The best communication products are specific to a named real audience and contain at least one accurately cited statistic.

Key resources and websites for this unit:

lsv.com.au/research/victorian-drowning-reports/ | beachsafe.org.au | royallifesaving.com.au | stjohndvic.com.au | victoriancurriculum.vcaa.vic.edu.au